

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form*(this is a two page report-click at the bottom for page 2)*

2000-66

rec'd 6/2/02

CBRC FILE #: _____
RESULTS: _____

Print this page and then fill out. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species (please include common and scientific names): Arctic Tern (*Sterna paradisaea*)

Date(s) of Observation: 10/8, 9/2000

Number of birds seen: 2

Sex:

Plumage: juv/1st winter

Exact location: Chatfield Reservoir

County: Douglas

Nearest town:

Elevation:

Length of observation:

Time(s) of observation:

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you:

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s):

Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s) and observer(s) position):

Optical equipment used:

Distance to bird(s) (estimated, unless otherwise noted):

Was (were) bird(s) photographed?

If so, are you submitting photos?

Who took the photograph(s)?

Describe the general and specific habitats in which the bird(s) occurred:

Describe the bird's (birds') behaviors, particularly behaviors that were used in supporting the identification, e.g., flying, feeding, habits:

Dick Schottler

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10/8, CHATFIELD S.P., DOUGLAS Co.

0720-0845; clear, cool (36°-40°), wind NW 0-3 mph

Birds seen included:

1. Sanderling (1, basic plumage)
2. Franklin's Gull ?
3. Ring-billed Gull (>20)
4. California Gull
5. Herring Gull (1)
6. Common Tern (2)
- * 7. Arctic Tern (1 juv. / 1st winter)
8. Forster's Tern (6)

A short trip to look for an Arctic Tern first found by Jay Kellner on 10/7 at the tip of the marina sand spit. There were several terns on the spit when I arrived. The Forster's Terns were obvious with their dark eye patches. Three "hooded" terns were present, two of which were Commons (dark carpal bars, longer legs) and the third was the Arctic Tern. What attracted my attention immediately was the very short legged appearance. When the tern waddled around, its belly almost touched the ground. The Arctic tern looked slimmer than the others, even though there didn't appear to be much difference in length. The head looked rounder than the Common Terns, and the black bill looked more "petite". The Common Terns bills were still partly reddish toward the base. The legs were very short and

(over)

looked reddish. The Arctic Tern had a carpal bar, but it was not as prominent as those on the Common Terns. In flight, the secondaries were white and appeared translucent as the bird banked in the morning sun. In flight, upper surface of wings and mantle faintly resembled the pattern of an imm. Sabine's Gull. The bird still showed some subtle "scalloping" on the mantle. The "hood" appeared to be quite black; on the Common Terns, it was more sooty gray.

Having the three species together was ideal for comparing them with each other.

10/9, CHATFIELD STATE PARK

1500-1630; clear, mild (~60°), calm

Birds seen included:

1. Osprey (1)
2. Ferruginous Hawk (1)
3. Common Tern (at least 1)
4. Arctic Tern (2)
5. Forster's Tern (at least 6)

Since a 2nd Arctic Tern was seen on the afternoon of 10/8, decided to go back on a beautiful fall day and study terns some more. Nice looks at all 3 species standing on the beach and flying. Of the 2 Arctic Terns, one was much more "scalloped" appearing

on the back than the other. Otherwise, description was as described for 10/8. One thing I noticed was the apparent difference in stance of the standing birds. On standing Common and Forster's Terns, the legs appeared vertical (or nearly so when viewed from head-on or tail-on). On the other hand, the short legs of the Arctic Terns appeared to angle in giving a "bow-legged" appearance.



10/10, CHATFIELD STATE PARK

1315-1540; clear, warm (70°), wind NW 0-5 mph

Birds seen included:

1. Pomarine Jaeger (1 ad., prob. ♂)
- * 2. PARASITIC JAEGER (1 juv.)
3. Sabine's Gull (1 juv.)
4. Common Tern (1)
5. Forster's Tern (several)

Back to Chatfield for the 3rd day in a row after hearing reports of two jaegers being seen there off-and-on over the past 2 days (but not I did to species). I was not disappointed - spent over 1 1/2 hours jaeger watching on another beautiful fall afternoon. Spent most of the time birding from the handicap fishing pier. Scanned the